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Local SEO Checklist for Small Businesses

Local search is won by being clear, consistent and useful. This checklist covers the profile, pages, reviews and signals that help nearby customers find and trust your business.

UPDATED NOVEMBER 2026 · 11 MIN READ · MIDNIGHTWEBS.COM

1. Define your service area and keep NAP consistent

Search engines and customers both need to know what you do, where you do it and how to contact you. Start with one source of truth.

- [ ] Write your business name, address and phone number exactly the same way everywhere.
- [ ] List the services you actually offer and the areas you realistically serve.
- [ ] Decide whether you serve customers at your address, at their location or both.
- [ ] Put the same details on your website, Google Business Profile and main directories.
- [ ] Remove old addresses, phone numbers and duplicate listings.

2. Complete and maintain Google Business Profile

Your profile is often the first local result a customer sees. Treat it as a live page, not a one-time setup.

- [ ] Choose the most specific primary category and add relevant secondary categories.
- [ ] Add hours, service area, phone, website, booking link and a short description.
- [ ] Upload real photos of the team, location, work and products.
- [ ] Post updates for offers, events and seasonal changes.
- [ ] Answer questions and respond to reviews promptly.

3. Build useful location and service pages

One thin page for every nearby town usually creates duplicate content. Build pages only where you can offer real local information.

- [ ] Create a page for each core service with clear pricing, process and examples.
- [ ] Add location pages only when you have unique local details, projects or teams.
- [ ] Include the city or service area naturally in the title, heading and body.
- [ ] Link related services and nearby locations to each other.
- [ ] Add directions, parking, opening hours and a map where relevant.

4. Add local on-page signals and schema

Make the page easy to understand for both people and search engines. Clear structure matters more than keyword repetition.

- [ ] Use one clear H1 and descriptive section headings.
- [ ] Write title tags and descriptions that mention the service and location.
- [ ] Show the business name, address and phone number on the contact page.
- [ ] Add LocalBusiness or appropriate Organization schema with accurate details.
- [ ] Embed a map only after the page is useful without it.

5. Earn reviews, citations and local links

Trust is built by repetition. Reviews, consistent listings and local relationships all reinforce the same message.

- [ ] Ask happy customers for a review at the right moment and make it easy.
- [ ] Respond to positive and negative reviews without arguing.
- [ ] Keep citations consistent on maps, industry directories and local associations.
- [ ] Sponsor or join local events, clubs or organizations that fit your business.
- [ ] Pitch a useful story or resource to local media, suppliers or partners.

6. Measure what local search produces

Rankings alone do not pay the bills. Track the calls, direction requests and enquiries that come from local search.

- [ ] Use Google Business Profile insights for calls, directions and website clicks.
- [ ] Track form submissions and calls with a dedicated number or UTM parameters.
- [ ] Check Search Console for local queries and pages with low click-through rates.
- [ ] Review your position for the services and areas that matter most.
- [ ] Update hours, offers and photos before busy seasons.

> **Do not mass-produce location pages:** five useful pages beat fifty pages with the same text and a swapped city name.